# Research with AI Agents

## What Works, What It Costs, and What an Institute Needs

Lukas Theissinger

October 30, 2026

# Outline

Staying Up to Date with AI

OpenAI and “Use Agents”

Owning Intelligence and Infrastructure at Lamarr

What to Watch in the Near Future

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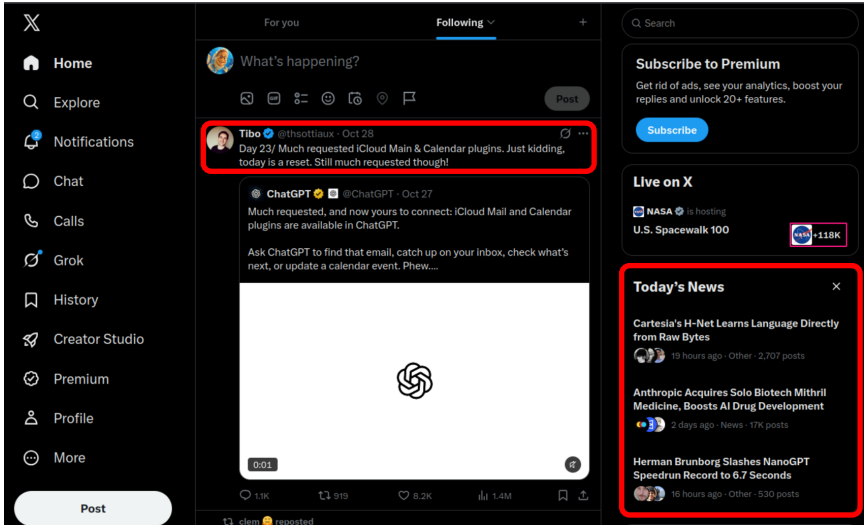
# How to Stay Up to Date

1. **Make an X (Twitter) account.**
   Many people from the frontier labs post there first, often daily.

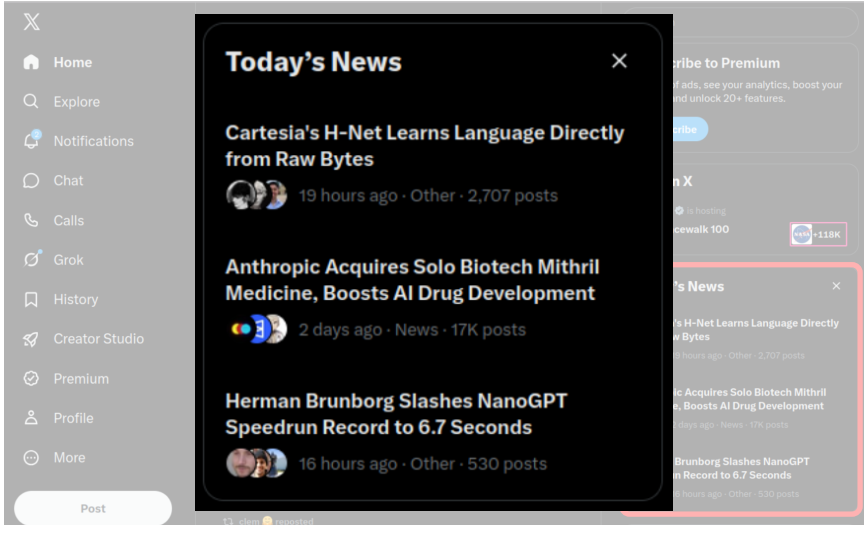
2. **Read "Today's News" on the home page.**
   It sums up the biggest updates of the day.

3. **Follow the right people.**
   Don't be fooled by clickbait.

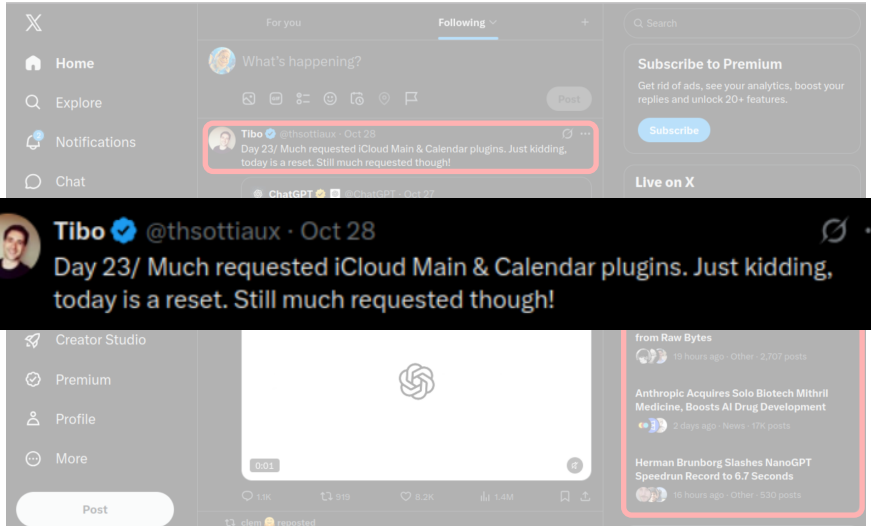
# Read Today's News



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**Tibo** @thsottiaux · Oct 28

Day 23/ Much requested iCloud Main & Calendar plugins. Just kidding, today is a reset. Still much requested though!

# Who to Follow and Why

| Who | Handle | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Andrej Karpathy | @karpathy | Clear explanations of LLMs and how to work with them |
| Thibault Sottiaux (tibo) | @thsottiaux | Leads OpenAI Codex; news on Codex releases and usage limits |
| Boris Cherny | @bcherny | Created Claude Code; how Anthropic uses its own agents |
| Tim Dettmers | @Tim_Dettmers | Agents in academic research; open models on small budgets |
| Victor Taelin | @VictorTaelin | Tests frontier models on hard coding problems |
| Felix Rieseberg | @felixrieseberg | Builds Claude's desktop apps at Anthropic; early product news |

*A few of the 251 accounts I follow, all of this kind.*

# A Recent Headline You Might Have Missed



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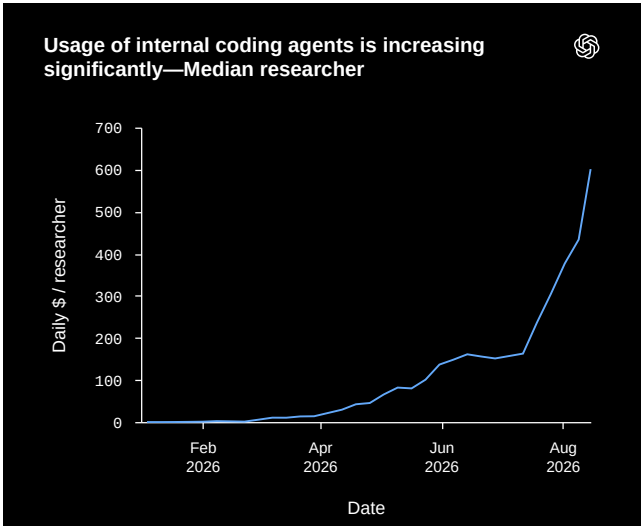
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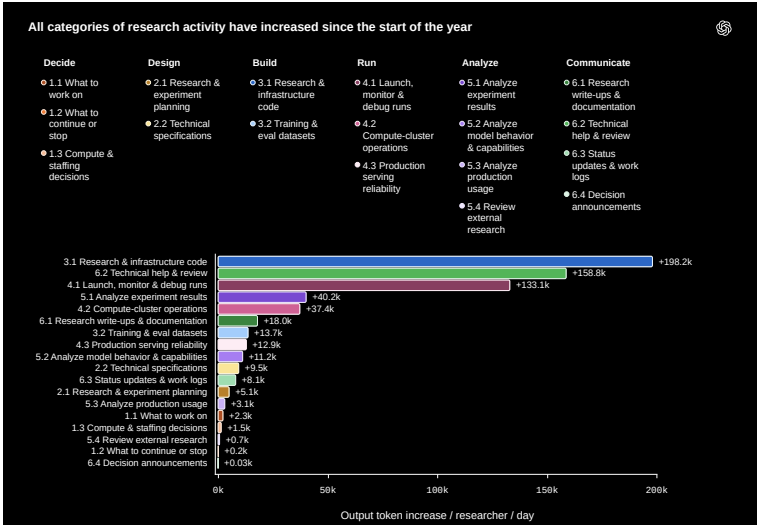
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# FOMO Headline: OpenAI Agent Usage



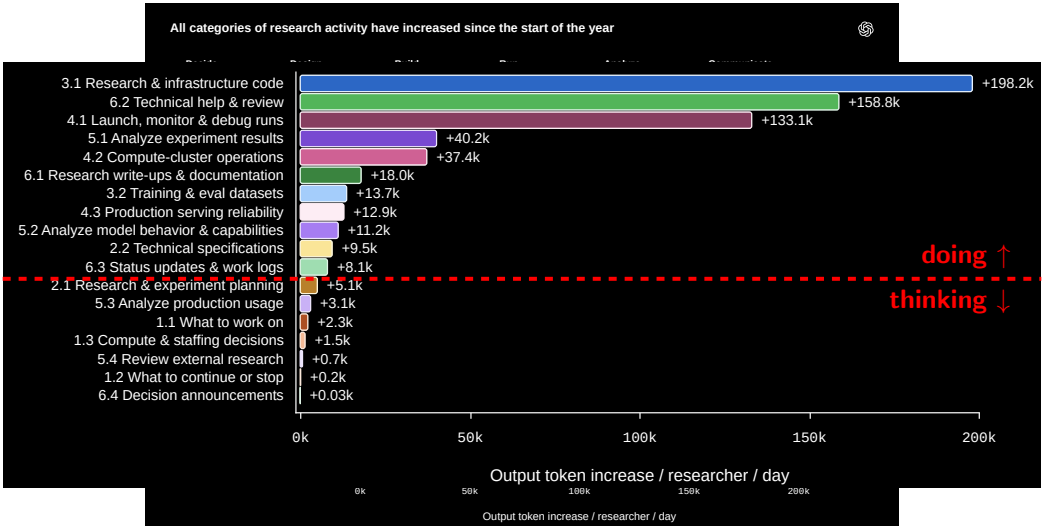

Median researcher, daily $ spent on internal coding agents. Source: OpenAI, "Research acceleration" (self-reported).

# What do agents do at OpenAI?




Increase in output tokens per researcher per day, by research activity. Source: OpenAI, "Research acceleration" (self-reported).

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# Use Agents or Be Left Behind

Tim Dettmers, January 2026

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Tim Dettmers (CMU / Ai2), blog post, January 2026

**The claim**

- "More than 90% of code and text should be written by agents."
- His blog posts: $>$ 95% AI-generated, he edits
- One post: days $\rightarrow$ $\sim$3 h
  1 h dictate, 10 min agent, 2 h review

**When it pays off**

- Automate only if
  how often $\times$ time saved $>$ time to build
- Otherwise: do it by hand
- His failure: email agent, 100+ h, net negative
- Agent use is a *skill*: practice, expect failures

Source: timdettmers.com/2026/01/13/use-agents-or-be-left-behind

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# Small Labs Can Compete

# What It Costs

# What an Institute Needs

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# Near-Term Developments

# Bend 2

# Takeaways